



USS *Hartford*

Farragut's flagship through the Civil War, the *Hartford* was a screw sloop of war that had been recently built. As usual for the time, it had a mix of steam propulsion and sails. Its armament included 20 9in (23cm) Dahlgren guns.

River and ocean setbacks

When Farragut led his ships up the Mississippi to Vicksburg in June 1862, he found that the Confederate fortress stood too high above the river for bombardment by his squadron's naval guns to have any real effect.

Returning to the sea, he worked tirelessly at the blockade of the Gulf ports, only to suffer a double blow in January 1863 when USS *Hatteras* was sunk by CSS *Alabama* off Galveston, Texas, and CSS *Florida* was allowed to escape from the port of Mobile, Alabama. On neither of these occasions was Farragut in personal command during the action. At Port Hudson the following spring, he was very much in charge. Apart from Vicksburg farther to the north, Port Hudson was the last remaining Confederate stronghold on the Mississippi River. In mid-March, Farragut planned to run seven